

Zimbabwe

 In 1980, the former British colony of Rhodesia became independent and took the name Zimbabwe, after the ancient city of Great Zimbabwe. About 70 per cent of Zimbabweans live from farming. Coal, gold, asbestos, and nickel are mined for export. Zimbabwe has recently suffered great disruption over the issues of government and land re-distribution.

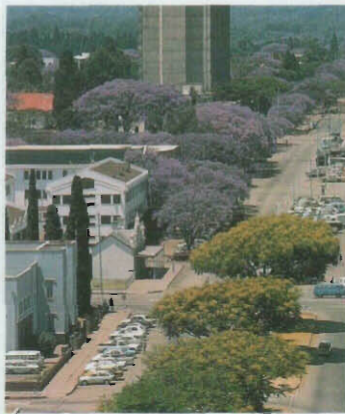


Tourism

Zimbabwe's main tourist attractions are the spectacular Victoria Falls, the Kariba Dam, national parks, and the ruins of the city of Great Zimbabwe. Tourists enjoy action holidays, such as canoeing and rafting, on the Zambezi.

ZIMBABWE FACTS

CAPITAL CITY	Harare
AREA	390,580 sq km (150,293 sq miles)
POPULATION	11,700,000
MAIN LANGUAGES	English, Shona, Ndebele
MAJOR RELIGIONS	Traditional beliefs, Christian
CURRENCY	Zimbabwe dollar



Harare

Formerly called Salisbury, the capital is Zimbabwe's commercial and industrial centre and home to almost two million people. It is a clean and sophisticated city that is characterized by flowering trees, colourful parks, and modern buildings.

MADAGASCAR FACTS

CAPITAL CITY	Antananarivo
AREA	581,540 sq km (224,533 sq miles)
POPULATION	15,900,000
MAIN LANGUAGES	Malagasy, French
MAJOR RELIGIONS	Traditional beliefs, Christian
CURRENCY	Malagasy franc

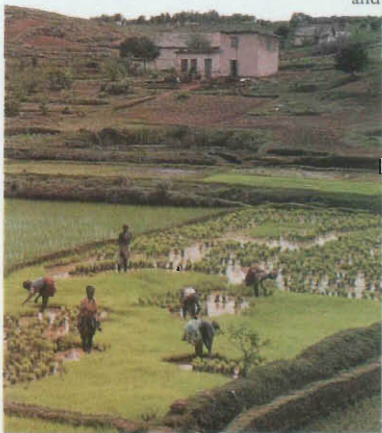
Vanilla

Madagascar is the world's largest exporter of vanilla. The pods of the plants are used to flavour ice-cream and chocolate. Other important cash crops are cloves, sisal, cocoa, and butter beans.

Vanilla pods grow 25 cm (10 in) long.

Rural society

Most Madagascans are descended from Asians from Malaysia and Indonesia, who began to settle on the island almost 2,000 years ago. Later waves of mainland Africans intermixed to produce a uniquely multiracial society. Three-quarters of the Madagascan labour force works on the land growing subsistence crops, such as cassava and rice.



Mozambique

 As a result of years of civil war, flooding, and drought, Mozambique is now one of the world's poorest countries, with a high birth rate. The land, though largely unexploited, is fertile and rich in minerals. The ports and railways provide a trade link for land-locked Swaziland, Malawi, and Zimbabwe.

Fishing

One of Mozambique's key industries is fishing, and shrimps account for more than 40 per cent of export earnings. The country's total annual fish catch averages 24,170 tonnes (26,643 tons). Other exports include cotton, tea, and sugar.



MOZAMBIQUE FACTS

CAPITAL CITY	Maputo
AREA	784,090 sq km (302,737 sq miles)
POPULATION	19,700,000
MAIN LANGUAGE	Portuguese
MAJOR RELIGIONS	Traditional beliefs, Christian, Muslim
CURRENCY	Metical

Malawi

 With few natural resources, Malawi has a rural society, despite the constant threat of drought. Light industries, such as food processing, textiles, and manufacturing farm tools, are developing. Fish from Lake Malawi, which covers one-quarter of the country, is a source of food.

Farming

Almost 86 per cent of the Malawi labour force works in agriculture, growing cash crops, such as tea, tobacco, coffee, cotton, and sugar, as well as subsistence crops of maize, rice, cassava, and plantains. The country is self-sufficient in food.

Tea grows well in the tropical climate of Malawi's hillsides.



Comoros

 The three islands and few islets of the Comoros archipelago lie north of Madagascar in the Indian Ocean. They were governed by France until 1975. The economy is underdeveloped, and most of the people live by subsistence farming.

Ylang-ylang

Comoros is the world's largest grower of ylang-ylang, an aromatic tree with greenish-yellow flowers that produce a pleasantly scented oil used to make perfume.

COMOROS FACTS

CAPITAL CITY	Moroni
AREA	2,230 sq km (861 sq miles)
POPULATION	694,000
MAIN LANGUAGES	Arabic, French, local languages
MAJOR RELIGIONS	Muslim
CURRENCY	Comoros franc